in the northeast. Hence, I directed that an Army Institute of Nursing be set up at Guwahati to meet the aspirations of children of our soldiers from this region, and was happy to inaugurate this college on 7 August 2006.

Rohini, in her position as president, Army Wives Welfare Association, instituted some pathbreaking measures to ameliorate the condition of widows of soldiers, and help them gain respect and financial security. She believed that the suffering of one widow was no less than that of the other, whether her husband was a battle casualty, or had died in circumstances attributable to military service, or died post-retirement. The empathy or approach required for reducing their suffering and providing the best opportunities for their children, was the same. This enabled her to address them as 'veer naris' and put across the need for their socioeconomic empowerment. She conceived the programme 'ability beyond disability', which aimed at removing the barriers that have relegated the disabled from the mainstream of life and aimed at reintegrating them by provision of assisting devices, rehabilitation training and opportunities for their economic empowerment. The project was successfully conducted with appliances worth Rs 2.3 crore distributed in twenty-one camps. Those camps were conducted with the support of ministry of social justice and empowerment.

Both Rohini and I have imbibed the values of helping the underprivileged from our parents, who suffered so much during Partition. Hence, we thought of bringing up and educating orphans or needy children. The first child whom we took under our wing was Kuljit, in 1997. He was all of seven years and came from a poor family in terrorist-infested Doda and Kishtwar area in Kashmir. An insecure lad, traumatized by the terrorism in his region, he took some time to settle down in Delhi. In his native village, he was taught in Urdu and didn't know a word of English. We put him in different schools depending on where I happened to be posted. He finished high school with credit, from the Army Public School, Delhi, and joined the army as a soldier as he was overage for the